

Build a Static Portfolio Layout in Laravel Blade

Goal

Build a Laravel demo app from the existing `staticWeb` portfolio template. Students will learn how to split a static HTML website into:

1. one main Blade layout
2. shared partials for navigation and footer
3. separate pages for Home, Resume, Projects, and Contact
4. public CSS, JavaScript, and image assets

What students will build

Routes:

- `/`
- `/resume`
- `/projects`
- `/contact`

Blade files:

- `resources/views/layouts/app.blade.php`
- `resources/views/partials/nav.blade.php`
- `resources/views/partials/footer.blade.php`
- `resources/views/pages/home.blade.php`
- `resources/views/pages/resume.blade.php`
- `resources/views/pages/projects.blade.php`
- `resources/views/pages/contact.blade.php`

Prerequisites

Students need:

- PHP installed
- Composer installed
- Node.js and npm installed
- a fresh Laravel project

Step 1: Create or open a Laravel project

Run this only if you do not already have a Laravel project.

```
composer create-project laravel/laravel portfolio-demo
cd portfolio-demo
```

If your teacher already gave you a project, open that project folder instead.

Step 2: Copy the static assets

The original static site keeps assets in:

- `staticWeb/css/styles.css`
- `staticWeb/js/scripts.js`
- `staticWeb/assets/favicon.ico`
- `staticWeb/assets/profile.png`

In Laravel, browser-accessible files go inside `public`.

Create these folders:

```
mkdir -p public/css public/js public/assets
```

Copy the files:

```
cp ../staticWeb/css/styles.css public/css/styles.css
cp ../staticWeb/js/scripts.js public/js/scripts.js
cp ../staticWeb/assets/favicon.ico public/assets/favicon.ico
cp ../staticWeb/assets/profile.png public/assets/profile.png
```

Checkpoint:

- `public/css/styles.css` exists
- `public/js/scripts.js` exists
- `public/assets/profile.png` exists

Step 3: Create the main layout

The layout contains the HTML document structure used by every page.

File: `resources/views/layouts/app.blade.php` Action: Create this file.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
  <head>
    <meta charset="utf-8" />
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1,
shrink-to-fit=no" />
    <meta name="description" content="@yield('description', 'Personal
portfolio demo built with Laravel Blade')" />
    <meta name="author" content="@yield('author', 'Laravel Student')" />
    <title>@yield('title', 'Personal Portfolio')</title>

    <link rel="icon" type="image/x-icon" href="{{ asset('assets/favicon.ico')

```

```

}}" />
    <link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.googleapis.com" />
    <link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.gstatic.com" crossorigin />
    <link href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Plus+Jakarta+Sans:wght@100;200;300;400;500;600;700;800;900&display=swap" rel="stylesheet" />
    <link href="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap-icons@1.8.1/font/bootstrap-icons.css" rel="stylesheet" />
    <link href="{{ asset('css/styles.css') }}" rel="stylesheet" />
</head>
<body class="d-flex flex-column h-100 @yield('body_class')">
    <main class="flex-shrink-0">
        @include('partials.nav')
        @yield('content')
    </main>

    @include('partials.footer')

    <script
src="https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/bootstrap@5.2.3/dist/js/bootstrap.bundle.min.js"
></script>
    <script src="{{ asset('js/scripts.js') }}"></script>
    @stack('scripts')
</body>
</html>

```

Important Blade syntax:

- `@yield('content')` means each page can insert its own content.
- `@include('partials.nav')` loads a shared file.
- `asset('css/styles.css')` creates the correct URL for files inside `public`.

Step 4: Create the navigation partial

File: `resources/views/partials/nav.blade.php` Action: Create this file.

```

<nav class="navbar navbar-expand-lg navbar-light bg-white py-3">
    <div class="container px-5">
        <a class="navbar-brand" href="{{ route('home') }}">
            <span class="fw-bolder text-primary">Start Bootstrap</span>
        </a>
        <button class="navbar-toggler" type="button" data-bs-toggle="collapse"
data-bs-target="#navbarSupportedContent" aria-controls="navbarSupportedContent"
aria-expanded="false" aria-label="Toggle navigation">
            <span class="navbar-toggler-icon"></span>
        </button>
        <div class="collapse navbar-collapse" id="navbarSupportedContent">
            <ul class="navbar-nav ms-auto mb-2 mb-lg-0 small fw-bolder">
                <li class="nav-item"><a class="nav-link" href="{{ route('home') }}">Home</a></li>
                <li class="nav-item"><a class="nav-link" href="{{ route('resume') }}">Resume</a></li>
            </ul>
        </div>
    </div>
</nav>

```

```

}}">Resume</a></li>
        <li class="nav-item"><a class="nav-link" href="{{
route('projects') }}">Projects</a></li>
        <li class="nav-item"><a class="nav-link" href="{{ route('contact')
}}">Contact</a></li>
    </ul>
</div>
</div>
</nav>

```

The static template used links like `index.html`. In Laravel, use route names like `route('home')`.

Step 5: Create the footer partial

File: `resources/views/partials/footer.blade.php` Action: Create this file.

```

<footer class="bg-white py-4 mt-auto">
    <div class="container px-5">
        <div class="row align-items-center justify-content-between flex-column
flex-sm-row">
            <div class="col-auto">
                <div class="small m-0">Copyright &copy; Your Website 2023</div>
            </div>
            <div class="col-auto">
                <a class="small" href="#">Privacy</a>
                <span class="mx-1">&middot;</span>
                <a class="small" href="#">Terms</a>
                <span class="mx-1">&middot;</span>
                <a class="small" href="{{ route('contact') }}">Contact</a>
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
</footer>

```

Step 6: Create the Home page

File: `resources/views/pages/home.blade.php` Action: Create this file.

```

@extends('layouts.app')

@section('title', 'Home | Personal Portfolio')

@section('content')
    <header class="py-5">
        <div class="container px-5 pb-5">
            <div class="row gx-5 align-items-center">
                <div class="col-xxl-5">
                    <div class="text-center text-xxl-start">
                        <div class="badge bg-gradient-primary-to-secondary text-

```

```

white mb-4">
                <div class="text-uppercase">Design &middot;
Development &middot; Marketing</div>
            </div>
            <div class="fs-3 fw-light text-muted">I can help your
business to</div>

            <h1 class="display-3 fw-bolder mb-5">
                <span class="text-gradient d-inline">Get online and
grow fast</span>
            </h1>
            <div class="d-grid gap-3 d-sm-flex justify-content-sm-
center justify-content-xxl-start mb-3">
                <a class="btn btn-primary btn-lg px-5 py-3 me-sm-3 fs-
6 fw-bolder" href="{{ route('resume') }}">Resume</a>
                <a class="btn btn-outline-dark btn-lg px-5 py-3 fs-6
fw-bolder" href="{{ route('projects') }}">Projects</a>
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
    <div class="col-xxl-7">
        <div class="d-flex justify-content-center mt-5 mt-xxl-0">
            <div class="profile bg-gradient-primary-to-secondary">
                
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
</div>
</div>
</div>
</header>

<section class="bg-light py-5">
    <div class="container px-5">
        <div class="row gx-5 justify-content-center">
            <div class="col-xxl-8">
                <div class="text-center my-5">
                    <h2 class="display-5 fw-bolder">
                        <span class="text-gradient d-inline">About Me</span>
                    </h2>
                    <p class="lead fw-light mb-4">My name is Start Bootstrap
and I help brands grow.</p>
                    <p class="text-muted">This Laravel demo converts the
original static HTML portfolio into reusable Blade layout, page, and partial
files.</p>
                    <div class="d-flex justify-content-center fs-2 gap-4">
                        <a class="text-gradient" href="#!"><i class="bi bi-
twitter"></i></a>
                        <a class="text-gradient" href="#!"><i class="bi bi-
linkedin"></i></a>
                        <a class="text-gradient" href="#!"><i class="bi bi-
github"></i></a>
                    </div>
                </div>
            </div>
        </div>
    </div>
</div>

```

```
        </div>
    </div>
</section>
@endsection
```

Step 7: Create the routes

File: `routes/web.php` Action: Replace the file content.

```
<?php

use Illuminate\Support\Facades\Route;

Route::get('/', function () {
    return view('pages.home');
})->name('home');

Route::get('/resume', function () {
    return view('pages.resume');
})->name('resume');

Route::get('/projects', function () {
    return view('pages.projects');
})->name('projects');

Route::get('/contact', function () {
    return view('pages.contact');
})->name('contact');
```

Checkpoint:

- `/` should show the Home page.
- `/resume`, `/projects`, and `/contact` will work after you create those page files.

Step 8: Create the other page files

Create these files using the teacher demo as reference:

- `resources/views/pages/resume.blade.php`
- `resources/views/pages/projects.blade.php`
- `resources/views/pages/contact.blade.php`

Each page starts with:

```
@extends('layouts.app')

@section('title', 'Page Name | Personal Portfolio')

@section('content')
```

```
<!-- Page HTML goes here -->
@endsection
```

For pages with a gray body background, add:

```
@section('body_class', 'bg-light')
```

Step 9: Run the Laravel app

```
php artisan serve
```

Open:

```
http://127.0.0.1:8000
```

Also test:

```
http://127.0.0.1:8000/resume
http://127.0.0.1:8000/projects
http://127.0.0.1:8000/contact
```

Common errors and fixes

Error: Route [home] not defined

Check that `routes/web.php` contains:

```
})->name('home');
```

Error: View [partials.nav] not found

Check that the file exists:

```
resources/views/partials/nav.blade.php
```

CSS is not loading

Check that this file exists:

```
public/css/styles.css
```

Check that the layout uses:

```
<link href="{{ asset('css/styles.css') }}" rel="stylesheet" />
```

Profile image is missing

Check that this file exists:

```
public/assets/profile.png
```

Check that the image uses:

```

```

Optional challenge

Improve the navigation by highlighting the current page.

Example:

```
<a class="nav-link {{ request()->routeIs('home') ? 'active' : '' }}" href="{{ route('home') }}">Home</a>
```